



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2018/2019

DIGITAL SCHOOL OF VIRTUAL AND OPEN LEARNING
SECOND-SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF
BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION
AEN 100: INTRODUCTION TO THE STUDY OF LANGUAGE

DATE: Monday, 15th April 2019

TIME: 2.00 p.m. - 4.00 p.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer question ONE and any other TWO

Question One is Compulsory (30 marks)

a) Explain the meaning relation in each of the following pairs of words: (20 marks)

- i. Sparrow and parrot.
- ii. Swoon and soon.
- iii. Dead and alive.
- iv. Sick and ill.

b) Identify and label all the phrases and clauses in the following sentence. (10 marks)

Because my coffee was too cold, I heated it in the microwave.

Question Two (20 marks)

a) With an example of each, describe the following concepts. (9 marks)

- i. Phoneme.
- ii. Phone.
- iii. Allophone.

b) With examples, explain what an artificial language is. (8 marks)

c) Define language. (3 marks)

Question Three (20 marks)

Explain the relationship between linguistics and the following:

- a) Sociology. (10 marks)
- b) Psychology. (10 marks)

Question Four (20 marks)

- a) Explain the relationship between language and the following areas of the brain. (8 marks)
 - i. Supplementary motor area.
 - ii. Wernicke's area.
- b) Describe any three distinct properties of human language. (12 marks)

Question Five (20 marks)

With an example of each explain the following concepts.

- a) Presupposition.
- b) Coherence.
- c) Cohesion.
- d) Speech act.
- e) Imperative sentence.



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2016/2017

THIRD SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS
AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

AEN 100: INTRODUCTION TO THE STUDY OF LANGUAGE

DATE: Thursday 27th July 2017

TIME: 2.00p.m-4.00p.m

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer **Question One** and any other **Two** Questions

Question One [Compulsory] (30 Marks)

- (a) Identify the morphemes in the following words and state whether they are free or bound.

[10 Marks]

- (i) Affordable
- (ii) Exaggeration
- (iii) Greenhouse
- (iv) Agreement
- (v) Handsome

- (b) With an example for each, distinguish between a morph and an allomorph. [6 Marks]

- (c) With two sentential examples for each, describe the following types of sentences.

[9 Marks]

- (i) Interrogative
- (ii) Imperative
- (iii) Declarative

- (d) Using an example of each, describe the difference between a main clause and a subordinate clause.

[5 Marks]

Question Two [20 Marks]

Discuss any four properties of human language and show how they contribute to the difference between human language and animal language.

Question Three [20 Marks]

- (a) Describe how linguistics relates to Sociology. [10 Marks]
- (b) Explain what is meant by the term “artificial language”. [10 Marks]

Question Four [20 Marks]

- (a) With examples for each, distinguish between conceptual and associative meaning. [8 Marks]
- (b) What is presupposition? [2 Marks]
- (c) With an example of each, describe what is meant by the following terms: [10 Marks]
 - (i) antonymy
 - (ii) homonymy
 - (iv) polysemy
 - (v) synonymy

Question Five [20 Marks]

- (a) Describe 3 parameters used in the description of vowel sounds. [6 Marks]
- (b) Draw and label the primary cardinal vowel chart. [5 Marks]
- (c) Distinguish between a phoneme, a phone and an allophone. [9 Marks]



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2010/2011

SECOND SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

AEN 100: INTRODUCTION TO THE STUDY OF LANGUAGE

DATE: TUESDAY 29TH MARCH 2011

TIME: 8.00 A.M. - 10.00 A.M.

INSTRUCTIONS

Answer THREE questions only.

Question ONE is compulsory.

Question One

- a) Discuss Four properties of natural human language that make it different from animal communication. (12 marks)
- b) Chimps have been trained to use language, with examples show how they have failed. (5 marks)
- c) Using four human speech organs, show how they have been adapted for speech production. (8 marks)
- d) What are the requirements of an ideal artificial language? (5 marks)

Question Two

- a)
 - i) Which part of the brain is responsible for speech production and comprehension? (3 marks)
 - ii) What are the main linguistics symptoms of a patient who has Broca's aphasia? (3 marks)

- b) Linguistics is said to be description and not prescriptive. Explain. (6 marks)
- c) Explain four features that make linguistics investigation scientific. (8 marks)

Question Three

- a) What are the main concerns of the following branches of linguistics. (6 marks)
- i) Historical linguistics
 - ii) Clinical linguistics
 - iii) Neurolinguistics
- b) i) What is meant by Speech Recognition and Speech Synthesis. (6 marks)
- ii) Discuss the practical application of Computational Linguistics. (8 marks)

Question Four

- a) Give four features of sign language that makes it similar to spoken language, and explain the similarity. (8 marks)
- b) Explain these concepts as used in sociolinguistics. (6 marks)
- i) Speech community
 - ii) A dialect
 - iii) Idiolect
- c) Discuss any three theories or myths of the origin of human language. Which one is more convincing and why? (6 marks)

Question Five

- a) The grammar of a language can be analyzed at five distinct levels. Discuss these levels with reference to English. (10 marks)
- b) Phonetics and phonology are closely related and so is morphology and syntax. Give reasons. (10 marks)

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